

John Hanacek

PRODUCT DESIGN ENGINEER · AI, WEB, 3D & XR
hi@johnhanacek.com · johnhanacek.com · linkedin.com/in/johnhanacek · github.com/jjh111 · San Diego or remote · US citizen

SUMMARY

Product design engineer, 14 years, across AI, web, 3D and XR. Shipped Nanome 2's XR and AI molecular design tools to pharma customers, an AR situational-awareness HUD for first responders, and a portfolio site whose search runs a language model in the browser. Founding design for early-stage teams through JHDesign LLC. Prototypes in code (JavaScript, Three.js, WebGL, WebGPU) and in Unity.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Design Engineer · JHDesign LLC 2024-now · San Diego / remote

- OpenProse (2026): founding design in two months. Brand, five logo directions, 37 homepage approaches built as live pages across 471 commits, one canonical style.
- Muse.bio (2024, 2026): user-journey and personas workshops; then a FigJam workshop the team ran itself plus a Claude Code + Figma MCP system that turns the output into structured results. Handed off entire.
- Transfyr (2025): MVP platform design handoff as Claude-generated HTML brought into Figma; synthetic data for the demo build; QA with their developer.
- JH Coaching OS: designed and shipped an AI coaching product (agent, materials, context docs, dashboard). Coaching founders on Claude Code and agentic workflows.

Lead XR Product Designer · Nanome Inc. 2022-2024 · San Diego

- Led product design for Nanome 2 on Meta Quest, the companion web portal and the Mara AI assistant. All shipped; supervised the visionOS beta.
- Ran ~24 alpha and beta sessions with scientists at Pfizer, Novartis and academic labs, coded the feedback, and acted as product lead in a PM, project manager and design triad (PRD template, tracking, Coda knowledge base, workshops).
- Replaced teleport navigation with Spotlight/Follow: labeled cursors and a shared, non-rivalrous molecule. It became a pillar of Nanome 2. Art directed look development.

Immersive UI/UX Designer · BadVR, Inc. 2021-2022 · Los Angeles / remote

- Designed the AROC situational-awareness AR HUD and its modular layout grid, with hand tracking on Meta Quest and HoloLens 2. Shipped.
- Bluetooth signal visualization for SeeSignal; the Munich Re damage-assessment demo over a simulated New York, with its manuals; a VR meteorology app.

Founding CEO/CTO, Co-Founder · AvatarMEDIC, Inc. 2019-2021 · San Francisco / San Diego

- Co-founded and led a medtech startup for remote trauma intervention through XR telepresence and robotics; Founder Institute SF (2020).
- Built the Unity robot demo, visual design, animatics and composites; the digital-twin robotic medical assistant won the Aerospace Medical Association's R&D Innovation Award (2022).
- Lead designer on three winning entries: HoloTRIAGE (Microsoft Reactor, 2020), A1R (NIST CHARIoT Phase 2, 2021), SAR 5G (AT&T 5G Hackathon, 2019).

UI/UX Design Lead · Collaborate.org 2015-2018 · Remote (hourly)

- Product design and interactive mockups, remote.

Graduate Associate · CNDLS, Georgetown University 2014-2015 · Washington, DC

- Pedagogical tools; co-authored EDULEARN15 research on the spread of technology-enhanced teaching.

Designer, Photographer, Product Maker · Independent practice (JHphotography, JHDesign) 2012-2024 · San Diego

- Websites, packaging, photography and media for small businesses; Blok Dok (2013), a wooden iPhone dock designed, made and sold; XR and 3D-scanning consulting.

Earlier: Photographer, Qualcomm Institute (Calit2) and UCSD Guardian; Ocean Lifeguard, California State Parks (2007-2012)

EDUCATION

MA, Communication, Culture & Technology · Georgetown University 2014-2016

Thesis: "As We May Sketch" · "Most Meta", voted by peers (2016)

BA, Political Science / International Relations; minor in Neuroscience · UC San Diego 2008-2012

SKILLS

Design & research: User research, usability testing, qualitative coding, 3D interaction design, design systems, brand, workshops, PRD and MVP scoping.

Figma · FigJam · Blender · Unity / C# · ShapesXR · Adobe Creative Suite

Code: JavaScript · TypeScript · React · HTML / CSS · Three.js · WebGL / GLSL · WebGPU · Node.js · Playwright · Git

AI & agentic: Context engineering, agent orchestration, tool-use design, retrieval-augmented generation, conversational UX. Claude Code · OpenCode · Hermes Agent · LM Studio · Ollama · MCP (Blender, Figma)

XR & robotics: Digital twins and teleoperation (Unity), 3D scanning and photogrammetry. Meta Quest · HoloLens 2 · Magic Leap One · visionOS

AWARDS

- 2022 AsMA R&D Innovation Award — XR digital-twin robot control
- 2021 NIST CHARIoT Challenge, Phase 2 winner — A1R augmented first responder
- 2020 Microsoft Reactor Hackathon winner — HoloTRIAGE on HoloLens 2
- 2020 Founder Institute San Francisco graduate
- 2019 AT&T 5G Hackathon winner, Best VR/AR/MR — SAR 5G on Magic Leap One
- 2016 "Most Meta", Georgetown CCT, voted by peers
- 2014 Kevin Kelly / The Technium future-vision challenge winner

TALKS & WRITING

AWE USA 2024 Lightning Round · XRDC 2024 mentor (Meta, ShapesXR, IDEO) · contributor, *Spatial Design: Breaking the 2D Paradigm* (2024) · EDULEARN15 paper on the spread of technology-enhanced teaching · Atlantic Council foresight essays on answer engines (2014)

